



Search suggestions popout on iPhone

phone as the remote internet connected device.

Orb has a Windows/Mac only client on the server side but on the remote device side any device with a Web Browser and a streaming media player will do. Hopefully Orb will come up with a Linux Client soon (your mileage with WINE may vary) and then it can proudly call itself completely platform independent.

On your laptop

As enunciated above, the laptop in this case will act like the streaming server via Orb. Orb can stream almost all kind of media including photographs, audio and video. It is assumed that the laptop has access to all the media you want to stream. The laptop is connected to a broadband Internet connection, preferably a proxy less line.

Your first step would be to obtain the Orb Client suitable for your system, you can get it either from http://www.orb.com/en/download_orb or if you are on Windows then you can find a copy of the latest setup (2.50+) on the Mindware DVD.

Installation has two major steps, the first being registering for your Orb account, if you already have one switch to the 'Login' tab at the prompt for registration and enter your 'Login Name' and 'Password'. If you don't have an account, it is important to register at this point as it will be difficult

to find the option for registering online. The next step during installation will be to select directories you want Orb to index in order to stream your media. You can add multiple paths and it automatically searches for all kinds of media it supports, recursively within

the directories.

Once it has finished indexing Orb will minimize to an icon in your notification tray, from where the Orb Control Panel can always be invoked to change indexed media settings and other modifications. It is recommended to have a decent processor and ample RAM for smooth on the fly encoding.

On your mobile

For the handset, we used a Nokia 5800 (running Symbian S60v5) as our remote device over an EDGE connection for accessing the media. Point your web browser to <http://mycast.orb.com/> and authenticate yourself with the login credentials. It is important to note, that you should try and use the default web browser of your device and not a third-party application such as Opera Mini or Opera Mobile, the reason behind this is that Opera won't be able to launch your device's media player and instead will give you a 'sdp' link to download.

Past this point, the interface



You can change your streaming settings from the Control Panel

is very intuitive. Whenever you will first try to stream it will do a self speed test, and the results will be displayed to you in Kilobits per second on the bottom right. Just below that in the bottom center, there is streaming quality selection bar, just click on any speed under or nearest to your network speeds, 80 might be a good compromise. The top navigation bar lets you select between Photographs, Audio, Video, TV (Only if you have a TV tuner card, else you would have to skip this option during installation) and File Browser mode, under each of them there is a similar interface with smart selections like most played and recently added.

One neat use we found of Orb was its ability to access the integrated web cam of your laptop if it has one, this can very easily be used as basic surveillance system. On a closing note we would like to point out that Orb enables the file browser function by default, so you are effectively streaming all your files (not just in the indexed directories) over the internet, so tread carefully.

Soundbooth CS4

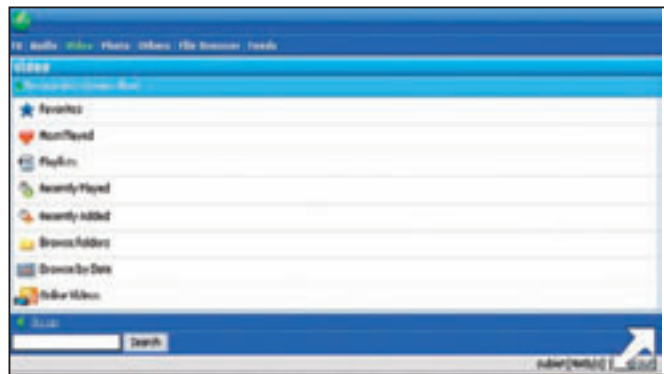
Adobe Soundbooth has always been the tool of choice for both amateur and semi-professional sound editing enthusiasts and now in its CS4 edition Soundbooth has added a whole lot more of functionality to an already impressive features

list. In this tips and tricks section we'll look at some of the basics and touch upon some of the new features; such as version control through Snapshots, multi-track mixing, extract audio feature and a whole lot more.

For the purpose of this tutorial we played around with a few stock sounds downloaded from www.freesound.org – a great resource for getting your hands on different sound samples such as loops, bass lines, synths and riffs.

Customising Workspace

Soundbooth's default workspace is full of panels and each panel has several tabs such as Effects, Markers, History, Properties etc. To the uninitiated it can all be a bit overwhelming. Thankfully Soundbooth allows you to customise and save your Workspace. There are three main panels on the screen apart from the main Editor window that shows your timelines. You can simply drag any of the tabs in the right panels into whichever section you desire. On dragging a tab you get a 3d box like indicator of where the tab will be placed. Dropping the tab when the central section of the box is highlighted will add it as a new tab in the same panel. Many of the tabs such as Properties, Video, Scores are not really required for quick access and you can simply close them by clicking on the X in the



Orb's Interface on your remote device